

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'The Stainless One'

Ārya Vimala nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 517 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་དེའི་མདེ་པ་ནས་བརྒྱུད་གི་ཟུངས།

Toh 517 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Vimala nāma dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as "The Stainless One" (Phags pa dri ma med pa zhes bya ba'i gzungs), belonging to the broader collection of noble dhāraṇīs. The text records a teaching delivered by the Buddha at Vulture Peak Mountain near Rājagṛha, addressed to the bodhisattva Viśuddhamati, and concerns the complete purity of the Tathāgata as expressed through moral discipline, meditative absorption, patience, and related virtues. As a dhāraṇī sūtra, it combines doctrinal exposition on the qualities of buddhahood with the sacred formulaic character typical of this genre of canonical literature. It is preserved in the Kangyur alongside a preceding dhāraṇī text known as the "Stack of Flowers," with which it shares a colophon, situating it within the dhāraṇī section of the collection.

The world rejoiced, and praised with delight what the Blessed One had spoken. The noble dhāraṇī called "Stack of Flowers" is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya Vimala nāma dhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: the noble dhāraṇī called "The Stainless One."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha on Vulture Peak Mountain. Then the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva Viśuddhamati:

Viśuddhamati, through the complete purity of moral discipline, the Tathāgata is completely pure. Viśuddhamati, through the complete purity of meditative absorption, the Tathāgata is completely pure. Viśuddhamati, through the complete purity of patience, the Tathāgata is completely pure. Viśuddhamati, through the complete purity of beneficial qualities, the Tathāgata is completely pure. Viśuddhamati, through the complete purity of loving-kindness, the Tathāgata is completely pure. Viśuddhamati, through the complete purity of compassion, the complete purity of joy, and the complete purity of equanimity, the Tathāgata is completely pure. Viśuddhamati, through the complete purity of liberation and the complete purity of the wisdom-vision of liberation, the Tathāgata is completely pure. Viśuddhamati, through the complete purity of powers, the complete purity of fearlessness, and the

complete purity of the buddha qualities, the Tathāgata is completely pure. Viśuddhamati, through the complete purity of the wisdom of omniscience, the Tathāgata is completely pure.

Viśuddhamati, whoever pays homage to a Tathāgata who is completely pure in such a way — honoring him with flowers, garlands, incense, parasols, victory banners, and so forth, with the sound of music and with ointments — no one can fathom the limit of that person's accumulation of merit. Its limit is this: except for reaching the final end of nirvāṇa through whichever of the three vehicles is appropriate, that accumulation of merit cannot be exhausted even at its ultimate end. Why is that? Viśuddhamati, just as all the buddha qualities of a Tathāgata are without measure, likewise the merit of one who makes offerings to a Tathāgata is without measure, without end, inconceivable, without equal, without number, beyond reckoning, and beyond expression.

Viśuddhamati, whoever pays homage to, venerates, depicts in images, makes offerings to, and reveres a Tathāgata who is presently dwelling and living and abiding — and whoever, in a future life, in the final five-hundred-year period, pays homage to, venerates, depicts in images, makes offerings to, and reveres even a relic of a Tathāgata who has passed completely into nirvāṇa, even one the size of a mustard seed — and who, with a mind properly settled and an awakening-oriented mind aroused, makes prostrations, pays respect, pays homage, venerates, depicts in images, makes offerings to, reveres, makes supplications, praises, and performs circumambulations — that person should understand five benefits. What are the five? One will come to possess mindfulness; one will come to possess realization; one will come to possess a sense of moral shame and propriety; one will swiftly come to behold the blessed buddhas; and having beheld them, one will come to generate faith. These are to be understood as the five benefits.

Then further, four things are to be understood. What are the four? Retaining word by word what the Tathāgata has taught,

practicing them just as they were taught, drawing close to the blessed buddhas, and swiftly being reborn in a perfectly pure buddha-field — these are the four things that one will come to fully retain.

Pure Wisdom, if a bodhisattva possesses four qualities, the māras and the sons of the gods in the retinues of the māras will not be able to defile him. What are the four? Being of noble lineage; from the very moment of birth, holding the blessed buddhas in mind; upholding the sacred Dharma in future times; and

being constantly blessed by the Tathāgatas, the arhats, the perfectly and fully awakened buddhas. Pure Wisdom, if a bodhisattva possesses these four qualities, the māras and the sons of the gods in the retinues of the māras will not be able to defile him.

Pure Wisdom, whoever has genuinely entered the vehicle of the bodhisattvas, upon seeing a stūpa of the Tathāgata, generates faith, touches both knees to the ground, makes prostration, and arouses this aspiration: "The Tathāgata's body is beautifully adorned with the thirty-two major marks of a great being — may I too attain a body just like that." Pure Wisdom, the mass of merit accruing from this cannot be expressed in words, for it abides in unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. That mass of merit cannot be exhausted even by a universal monarch, or by Śatakratu (Indra, lord of the gods), or by Brahmā, or by a śrāvaka, or by a pratyekabuddha, or even by one who has attained unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening. Why is that? Pure Wisdom, it is because that son of noble family or daughter of noble family has fully grasped an inconceivable mass of merit.

Pure Wisdom, consider this example. A Tathāgata who has manifestly and perfectly awakened to unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — whether he enters a city, a temple, or a village, whether the Tathāgata walks, strolls, stands, sits, or teaches the Dharma — in the great trichiliocosm, there is not a single sentient being, whether a god, a nāga, a yakṣa, a gandharva, an asura, a garuḍa, a kinnara (a being half-human), a great serpent, a human, a non-human, a tree, a mountain, a burrow, or a bird's nest, that does not bow toward the Tathāgata's presence, bow deeply, or prostrate fully. Just as all beings bow, deeply bow, and fully prostrate before the Tathāgata who is endowed with all wholesome roots, so too will all sentient beings bow, deeply bow, and fully prostrate before those sons and daughters of noble family who wander through villages, towns, hamlets, regions, or the surroundings of a palace.

Homage to the Blessed One Amitābha.

Amita, amite prabhava mahāprabhe, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati, prabhavati. Blessed One, may your power be displayed. Blessed One, may your power be displayed. Tadyathā: mati mati, mati mati, mati mati, mati mati, mati mati, smṛti smṛti, smṛti smṛti, smṛti smṛti, smṛti smṛti, smṛti smṛti, mahāsmṛti, mahāsmṛti. May attachment be removed and delusion dispelled.

Some some, some some, some some, some some, some some, saumanasyam upanaya.

Saumanasyam upanaya. Saumanasyam upanaya. Saumanasyam upanaya. Saumanasyam upanaya. Saumanasyam upanaya. Saumanasyam upanaya. Saumanasyam upanaya. Śikhi śikhi. Śikhi śikhi. Śikhi śikhi. Śikhi śikhi. Śikhi śikhi. May there be peace. May there be freedom from illness. May there be freedom from obstacles. Prabhavati. Mahāmatye. Raśmi raśmi. Raśmi raśmi. Raśmi raśmi. Raśmi raśmi. Raśmi raśmi.

The names of these buddhas, these Blessed Ones, should also be held in mind and venerated. They are as follows: the Blessed One Ratnasambhava, the Blessed One Ratnasūrya, the Blessed One Ratnottama, the Blessed One Ratnadṛḍha, the Blessed One Ratnaketū, the Blessed One Ratnaprabhā, the Blessed One Ratnatejas, the Blessed One Akṣobhya, the Blessed One Amitābha, the Blessed One Amitasvara, the Blessed One Duṣprasaha, the Blessed One Anantayaśas, the Blessed One Ratnaprabhā, the Blessed One Mahāsukhāprāpta, the Blessed One Nakṣatraprabhā, the Blessed One Satyasvara, the Blessed One Rogamaladvivarjita, the Blessed One Śuklacandra, the Blessed One Vimalaprabha, the Blessed One Śuklasūrya, the Blessed One Sūryaprabha, the Blessed One Viśuddhaprabha, the Blessed One Anantaratna, the Blessed One Ratnagarbha, the Blessed One Ratnasambhava, the Blessed One Candradīpa, the Blessed One Padmasenā, the Blessed One Padmaghoṣa, the Blessed One Padmaśrī, the Blessed One Guṇaśrī, the Blessed One Suvarṇaprabha, the Blessed One Brahmeśvararāja, the Blessed One Suvarṇābha, the Blessed One Suvarṇākara, the Blessed One Nāgeśvararāja, the Blessed One Puṣpa, the Blessed One Sarvagandhaiśvararāja, the Blessed One Mālyarāja, the Blessed One Sthirasenā, the Blessed One Śastrāparivarjita, the Blessed One Śrīgarbharatnamaṇiprabha, the Blessed One Apramitajñānaprabha, the Blessed One Siṃhaghoṣa, the Blessed One Siṃheśvararāja, the Blessed One Mahātejavīryanairyāṇika, the Blessed One Garbhāvabhāsita, the Blessed One Dundubhighoṣarāja, the Blessed One Candraśrī, the Blessed One Padmāvabhāsa, the Blessed One Lokapradīpa, the Blessed One Agni, the Blessed One Bhayaṃkara, the Blessed One Ratnavalaya, the Blessed One Nityaparinirvṛta, the Blessed One Udāramati, the Blessed One Apramitaratnasphuṭaprabha, the Blessed One Sumeruvidhvaṃsana, the Blessed One Ratnaśrīpāṇi, the Blessed One Ratnasamcayaśrī, the Blessed One Anāvartacakraratnapadaśrī, the Blessed

One Samantavairocanaviśuddhiprāpta, the Blessed One Sūryacandrapradīpa, the Blessed One Parvata, the Blessed One Mahāparvata, the Blessed One Sumeru, the Blessed One Suparvata, and the Blessed One Sumeruprakāśa.

Tadyathā: paṭa paṭa, dama dama, ghama ghama, svāhā.

I bow down to all the Blessed One buddhas who abide in the eastern direction, together with their retinues — those guides — and to all of them. I request that they too protect me and my retinue, manifestly granting freedom from illness and peace. I bow down to all the Blessed One buddhas who abide in the southern direction — those guides. I request that they too protect me, granting freedom from illness and peace. I bow down to all the Blessed One buddhas who abide in the western direction — those guides. I request that they too protect me, granting freedom from illness and peace. I bow down to all the Blessed One buddhas who abide in the northern direction — those guides. I request that they too protect me, granting freedom from illness and peace. I bow down to all the Blessed One buddhas who abide in the direction below — those guides. I request that they too protect me, granting freedom from illness and peace. I bow down to all the Blessed One buddhas who abide in the direction above — those guides. I request that they too protect me, granting freedom from illness and peace. I bow down to all the Blessed One buddhas who abide in the intermediate directions — those guides. I request that they too protect me, granting freedom from illness and peace.

Tadyathā: vimale, vimalakare, vimalasaṃbhava, svāhā. Vimale, vimale, vimale, vimale, vimale, vimale, vimale, vimale, vimale, vimale. Vimalākare, vimalākare, vimalākare, vimalākare, vimalākare, vimalākare, vimalākare, vimalākare, vimalākare, vimalākare. Vimalasamudbhava, vimalasamudbhava, vimalasamudbhava, vimalasamudbhava, vimalasamudbhava, vimalasamudbhava, vimalasamudbhava, vimalasamudbhava, vimalasamudbhava, vimalasamudbhava.

This vidyā mantra is a great vidyā mantra,
proclaimed by the gods themselves.

When it is recited at the three times,
one is fully liberated from all illness.

Whatever harm non-humans have done,
whatever evil deeds have been bound — one is freed.

Mindfulness of those things will not be forgotten,
and whatever has been grasped will not be wasted.

In all those births,
one will never be parted from the buddhas.
Whoever joyfully holds this immaculate dhāraṇī,
wandering through all the fields of existence,
is born at the heart of a glorious lotus,
well adorned with all the major marks,
with a net of rays of light streaming from every limb.

Tadyathā: kuṭi kuṭi, kucchalo, ela ela, mukta, koṭathālo, eriri, rimṛti, svāhā.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva great being Viśuddhamati, together with the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had declared.

The noble dhāraṇī called Immaculate is complete.

Translated by the Indian masters Jinamitra and Dānaśīla —

Translator's Notes

- The bodhisattva name འཕུལ་ཆོས་ཀྱི་མཚན་ལྡན་པའི་བློ་བཟང་པོ་ is rendered as Viśuddhamati, its standard Sanskrit equivalent meaning "one of completely pure intelligence." The text breaks mid-sentence at the end, as the source passage itself is clearly incomplete. The term འཕུལ་ཆོས་ཀྱི་མཚན་ལྡན་པའི་བློ་བཟང་པོ་ (literally "the substance of benefit") in the list of Tathāgata qualities is slightly unusual; it may refer to the quality of beneficence or altruistic conduct, rendered here as "beneficial qualities." The passage opens with the colophon of one dhāraṇī text and immediately transitions into the opening of the next, which is standard in Tibetan canonical collections.
- The passage concludes with a dhāraṇī formula. The Sanskrit syllables are reproduced as they appear in the Tibetan transliteration without attempt to emend or interpret them doctrinally, as is standard for dhāraṇī passages. The final phrase "saumanasyam upanaya" means approximately "bring about gladness of mind" and is rendered in transliteration following the convention for mantra passages. The term rendered "great serpent" for "lto 'phye chen po" is a giant serpent or python figure; some editions understand this as a category of nāga-like beings distinct from nāgas proper. The line "ching bu'am bya skyibs" rendered as "burrow or bird's nest" may alternatively refer to hollow trees and shelters, but the general sense of encompassing all locations is clear and consequential here.
- The buddha names throughout this passage are epithets rendered into Sanskrit from their Tibetan translations. Several names appear twice in the list, notably Ratnasambhava and Ratnaprabhā; this is as the Tibetan text has it and is not a translation error. The name rendered Ratnadṛḍha follows the Tibetan རིན་ཆེན་མཁྱེད་, meaning "hard" or "firm" jewel; the precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain but Ratnadṛḍha is a reasonable reconstruction. Sthirasenā follows dpa' brtan pa'i sde, "host of the steadfast hero." Śāstrāparivarjita follows mtshon cha spong, "one who has relinquished weapons." Garbhāvabhāṣita follows snying pos zil gnon, "outshone by the essence," though the precise intended Sanskrit is uncertain. Apramitajñānaprabha follows dpag med rtogs 'od, literally "light of boundless realization."

Anāvartacakraratnapadaśrī follows phyir mi ldog pa'i 'khor lo rin po che'i tshig gi dpal, "glory of the words of the precious wheel of non-regression."

- The Sanskrit mantra syllables are transcribed from Tibetan phonetic rendering and some forms are irregular or corrupt in transmission. The form "vimalasamudbhava" is a reasonable reconstruction of the Tibetan "bi ma la sa muṭ ga te," though the underlying Sanskrit is uncertain. The colophon ends mid-sentence, cutting off after the names of the Indian paṇḍitas Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, indicating the text continues with the names of the Tibetan translator(s), which are not included in this passage.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.